3. It enlarged the deliberative functions of the legislative councils at both levels. For example, members were allowed to ask supplementary questions, move resolutions on the budget and so on.

4. It provided (for the first time) for the association of Indians with the executive councils of the viceroy and Governors. **Satyendra Prasad Sinha** became the first Indian to join the viceroy's executive council. He was appointed as the Law Member.

5. It introduced a system of communal representation for Muslims by accepting the concept of 'separate electorate'. Under this, the Muslim members were to be elected only by Muslim voters. Thus, the Act 'legalised communalism' and Lord Minto came to be known as the **Father of Communal Electorate**.

6. It also provided for the separate representation of presidency corporations, chambers of commerce, universities and zamindars.

 **Government of India Act of 1919**

On August 20, 1917, the British Government declared, for the first time, that its objective was the gradual introduction of responsible Government in India[7].

The Government of India Act of 1919 was thus enacted, which came into force in 1921. This Act is also known as Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (Montagu was the Secretary of State for India and Lord Chelmsford was the Viceroy of India).

The features of this Act were as follows:

1. It provided for the classification of all the subjects of administration into two categories, namely, the central subjects and the provincial subjects. This classification was done by the "Devolution Rules" framed under the Act. These rules facilitated the delegation of authority from the centre to the provinces. In this way, the Act relaxed the central control over the provinces. The central and provincial legislatures were authorised to make laws on their respective list of subjects. However, the structure of government continued to be centralised and unitary.

2. It further divided the provincial subjects into two parts—transferred and reserved. The transferred subjects included public health, education, local self-government, agriculture etc. while the reserved subjects included police, administration of justice, prisons, land revenue, finance etc. The **transferred subjects** were to be administered by the Governor with the aid of Ministers responsible to the legislative council. The **reserved subjects**, on the other hand, were to be administered by the Governor and his executive council without being responsible to the legislative council. This dual scheme of governance was known as 'dyarchy'—a term derived from the Greek word *di-arche* which means double rule. However, this experiment was largely unsuccessful.

3. It introduced, for the first time, bicameralism and direct elections in the country. Thus, the Indian legislative council was replaced by a bicameral legislature consisting of an Upper House (Council of State) and a Lower House (Legislative Assembly). The majority of members of both the Houses were chosen by direct election.